PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION · JUST RUN IT

User Guide

How to define work, run it on the hosts that have the files, and see what happened. Screenshots are from the current console. Names and counts differ in each deployment.

1. What you can run

People define jobs, order them into workflows, and schedule the result. An agent on the host calls out, claims the queued run, and posts the outcome. The control plane does not open a connection to the agent, and agents do not connect to the database.

JOB TYPE	SUCCESS	WHERE IT RUNS
COMMAND	The process exits 0. Linux uses `/bin/sh -c`. Windows uses `cmd.exe /c`.	The agent host, or the control plane in a lab
HTTP	GET returns 200–299. Status and body are stored on the execution.	The host that claims the job
GIT_RELEASE	The release asset is downloaded into the cache on that host and then executed.	The host that claims the job
NOOP	Succeeds immediately. Useful for wiring a workflow.	Either

Turning a job off skips new scheduled runs and refuses a manual run. A run that is already queued or running continues until it finishes, times out, or is cancelled.

A workflow is an ordered list of jobs. A later step can require success, run anyway, or run only after a failure. You can restart a workflow execution from a chosen step. A schedule is a six-field cron expression, including seconds, on a job or a workflow. In the console the schedule form uses the numeric id shown on the list. The job file, described below, moves the same objects by workspace and name.

2. Agents, pools, and the account

The agent process opens HTTPS to the control plane, registers under its own name, sends a heartbeat, and asks for work. The name is the routing key. The hostname is a label. Registering the same name again reconnects that agent. A different name is a different agent.

POOL	PREFERRED AGENT	WHO TAKES THE NEXT RUN
None	Empty	Any online agent with free capacity
Set	Empty	Any online member of that pool
Either	One name	Only that agent. The job waits if that host is down or full
Empty pool	Empty	Nobody, until agents join the pool

Set the preferred agent to the agent name, not the hostname, unless you also named the agent that way. Members of a pool need the same scripts and paths, because either online member may take the next job. Adding or removing a member does not move a run that is already in progress.

One agent process runs one job, then asks for the next. Capacity is how many claims the control plane will hand that name. The load shown in the console is the work actually running. To run several jobs at the same time on one machine, run several agent processes.

On Linux the agent refuses to start as root. The command has only that account’s rights. There is no setting to run one job as another user. Two jobs that need different rights use two agents, usually in two pools. Packaged containers drop extra privileges and keep the root filesystem read-only. The job can write its temporary directory and its artifact cache.

A remote agent uses a confidential client and a short-lived token. The server address and the token address must be HTTPS unless the host is localhost. The agent does not use a person’s password in that mode. Agents on a private network may use a local operator login. A public entrance can refuse that password.

```
java -jar automation-agent.jar --server https://control.example.com --name finance-host-01 --hostname
finance-01.corp --user operator --password <secret>

java -jar automation-agent.jar --server https://control.example.com --name finance-host-01 --client-id
justrunit-agent --client-secret <secret> --token-url https://login.example.com/oauth/token
```

Token settings can also come from `AUTOMATION_CLIENT_ID`, `AUTOMATION_CLIENT_SECRET`, and `AUTOMATION_TOKEN_URL`. On Windows, install Java 21 and run the same JAR under Task Scheduler or a service wrapper. Use Windows paths in COMMAND jobs that must run on that host.

3. Who can do what

Sign-in role and workspace membership are both required. A viewer who owns a workspace is still read-only.

SIGN-IN ROLE	WHAT THAT PERSON CAN DO
Viewer	Read definitions, history, logs, and agents. Cannot create, edit, run, schedule, register, or remove, even as a workspace owner.
Operator	Run, cancel, and requeue. Create and edit in workspaces they manage. Register and remove agents. Call the API. A member who is only an operator can run and cannot edit.
Admin	Every workspace. Users, groups, agent pools, the job file, and deletes. The API catalog and the Health link in the menu are for administrators.

Workspaces are personal, group, or platform. Platform is visible to everyone signed in. Only an administrator changes it. Membership in one group does not open another group’s jobs. Company SSO can be Entra ID, Okta, or Keycloak, including a host that accepts SSO only. Identity-provider groups map to the sign-in role.

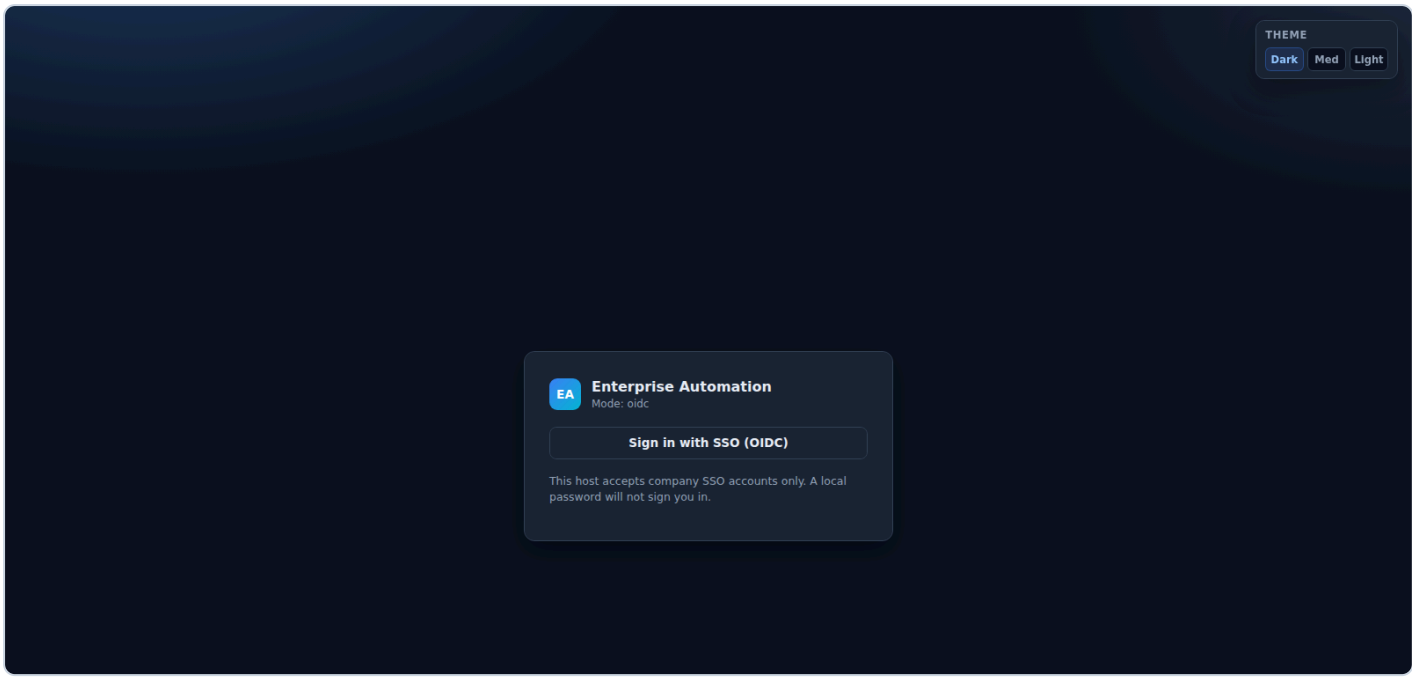
Operators and the agents call `/api/v1`. Viewers do not, and they do not get the API catalog. Health, readiness, and the Prometheus endpoint stay available for probes. Creates and updates of jobs, workflows, and schedules record the person, the time, and the fields before and after, for workspaces that person can already see. Administrators see every diff. Execution history is the run log, not a field-by-field config change.

Administrators export jobs, workflows, and schedules as JSON. The file matches objects by workspace and name. It does not carry database ids, agent hostnames, pool members, or run history. Upload does not write. Review offers add, update, and remove. A file of three jobs does not delete the others unless each removal is confirmed. A new schedule, and a change that would leave a schedule enabled, starts unchecked. Before apply, the current definitions of those workspaces are snapshotted. Restore uses the same review. History deleted with a job is not restored. The same file can move environments when the workspace and pool names match. The machines behind the pool can differ.

4. The console

Sign-in

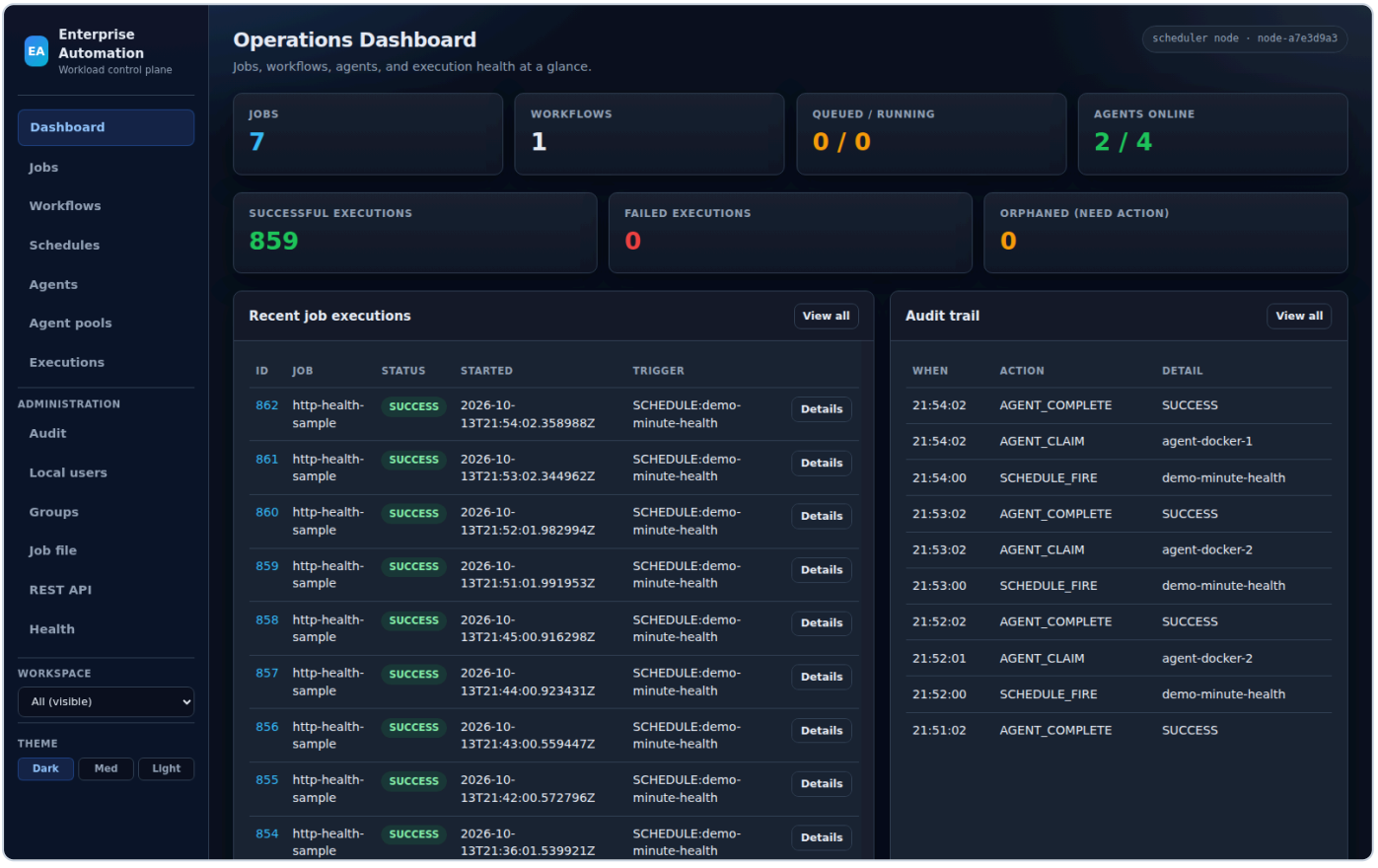
Production hosts use company SSO. This host is set so a local password will not sign you in. Dark, medium, and light themes are available before and after sign-in.



Sign-in. Company SSO. Identity-provider groups map to Admin, Operator, and Viewer.

Dashboard

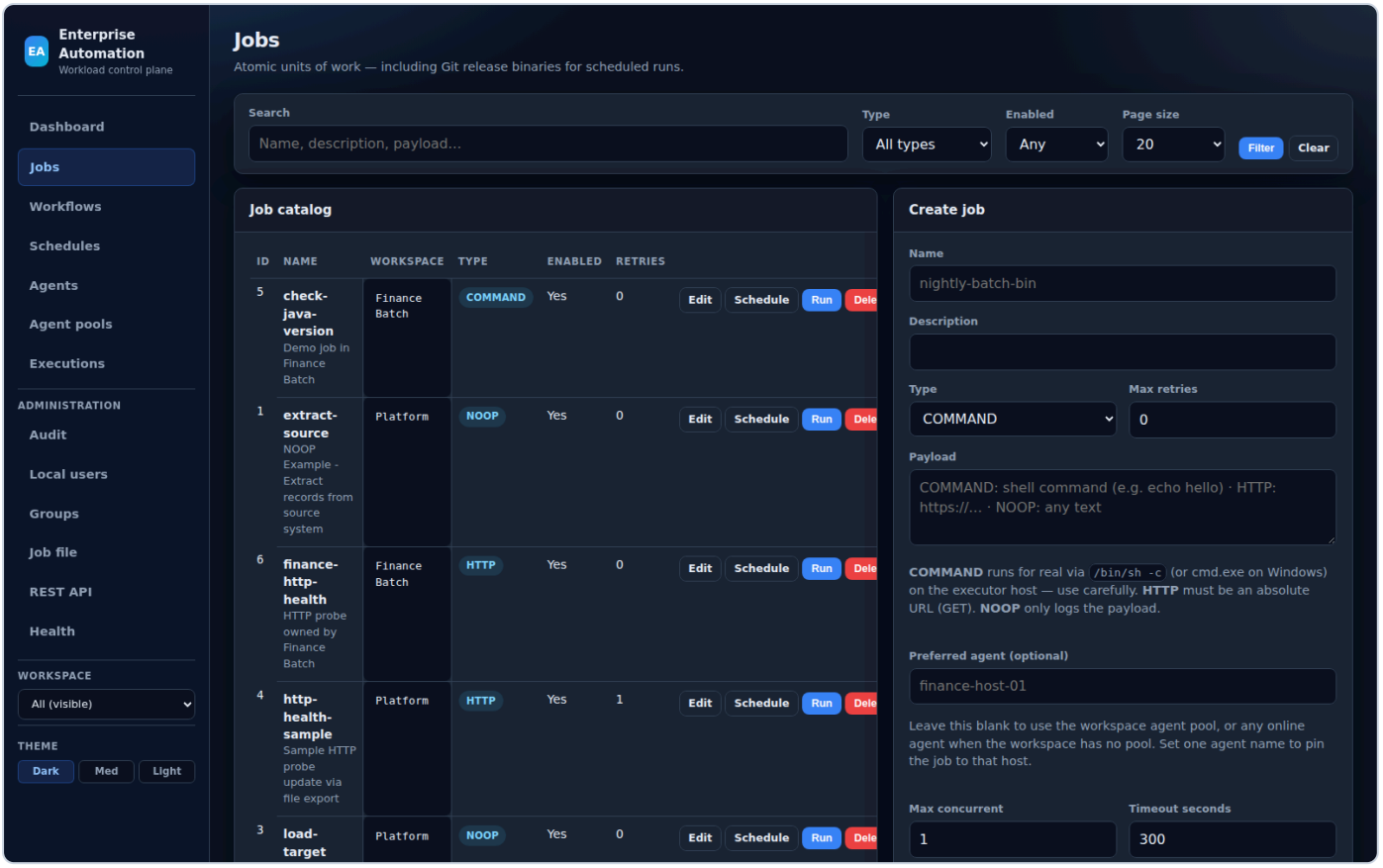
Counts, agents online, recent executions, and the latest audit events. The scheduler lease keeps a single scheduler when more than one application node is running.



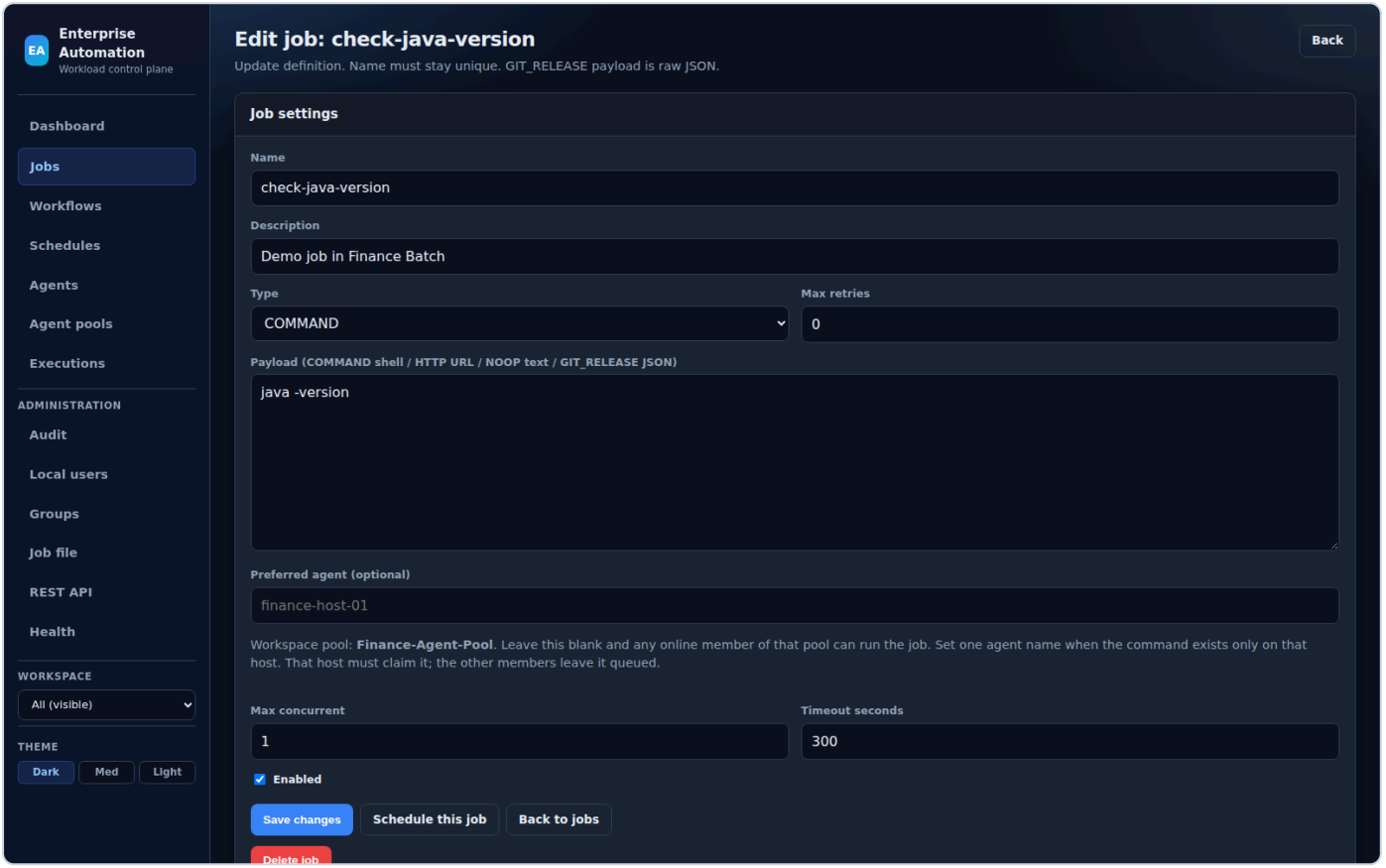
Dashboard. Queued and running work, agent availability, and recent runs.

Jobs

Search and filter the catalog. Operators run, edit, and schedule. Administrators can delete a job, which also deletes its history. A workspace column shows which team owns the definition.

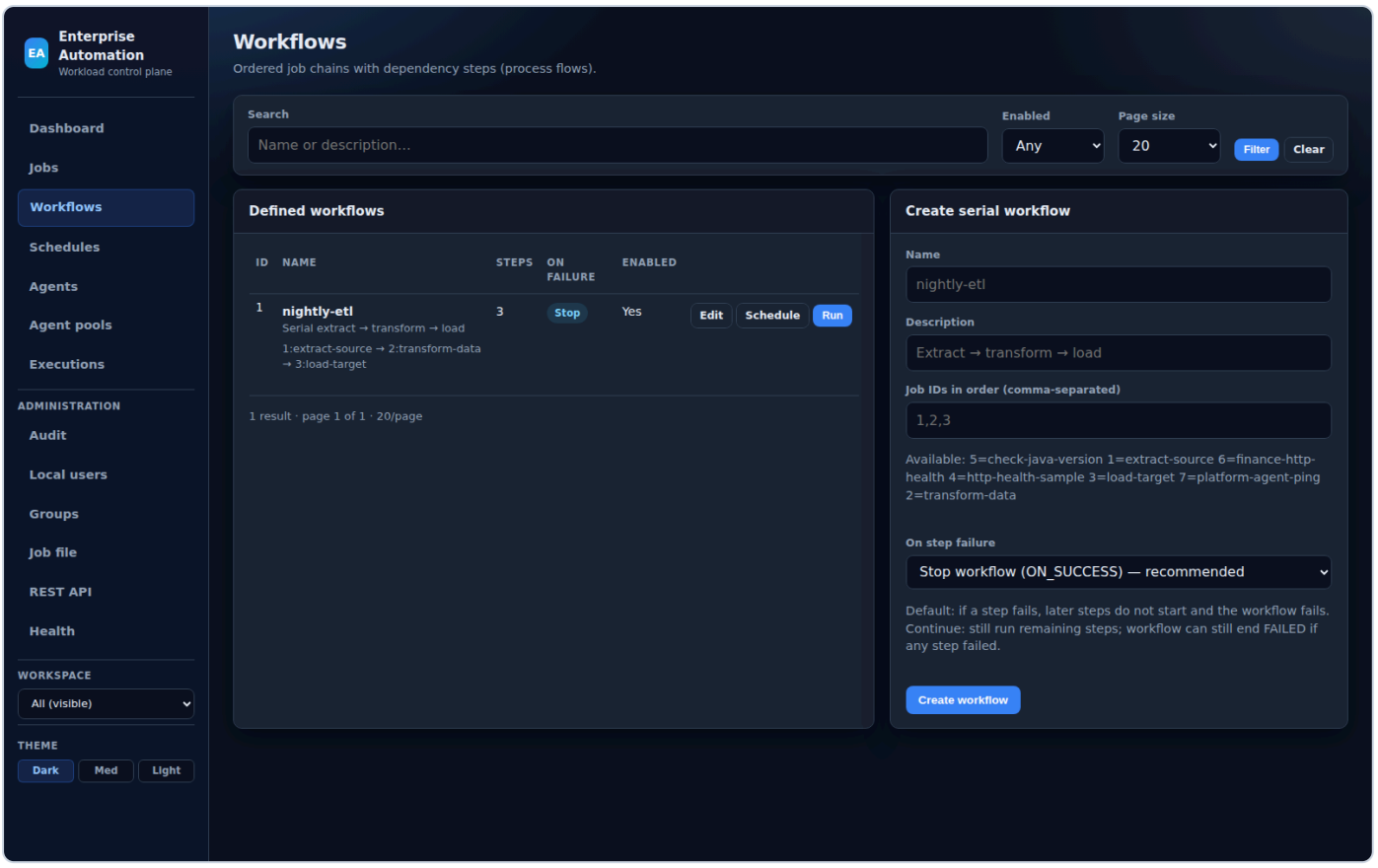


Jobs. Catalog, run, and the form for a new job.

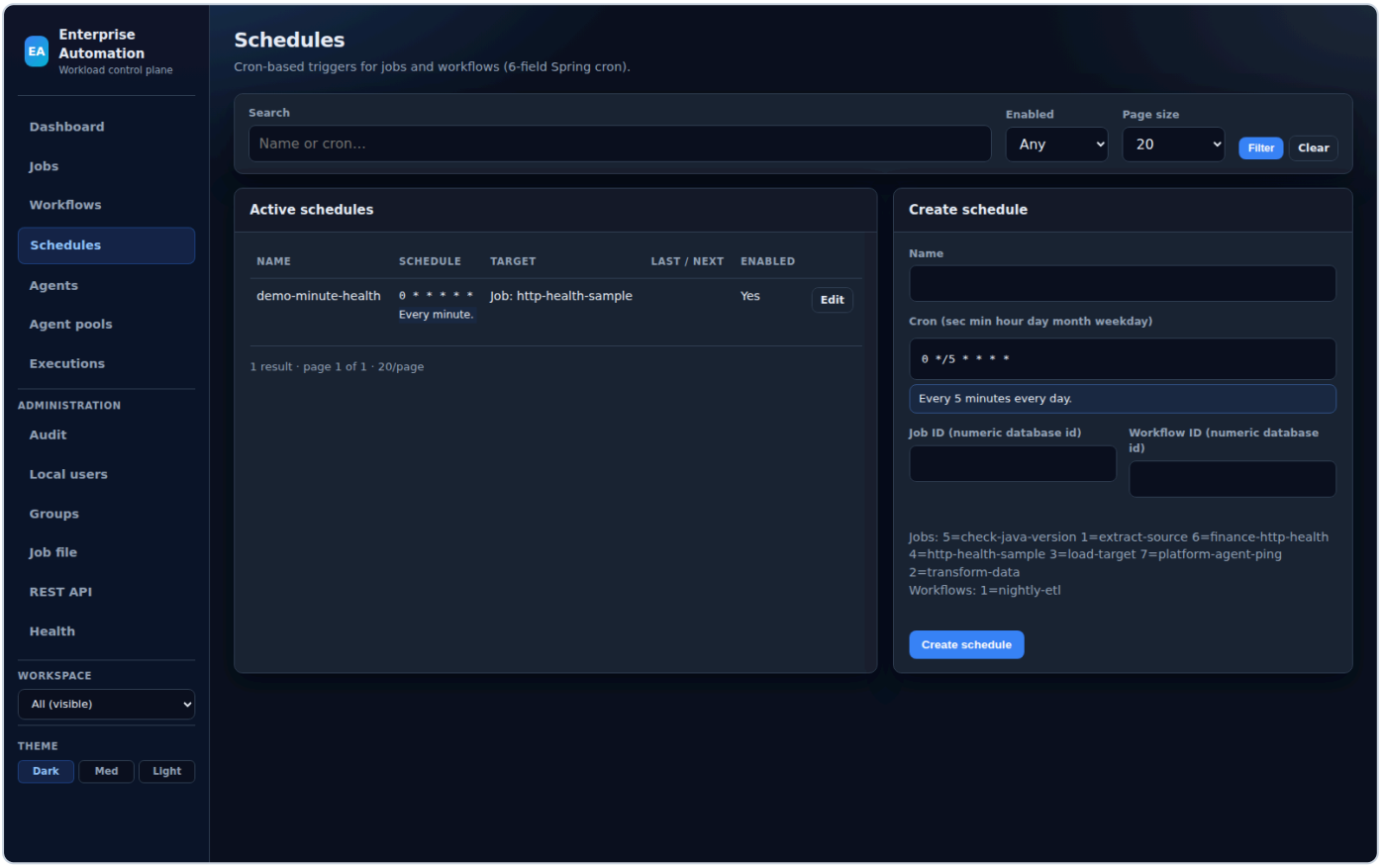


Job editor. Leave preferred agent blank to use the workspace pool. Set one name when the command exists only on that host.

Workflows and schedules

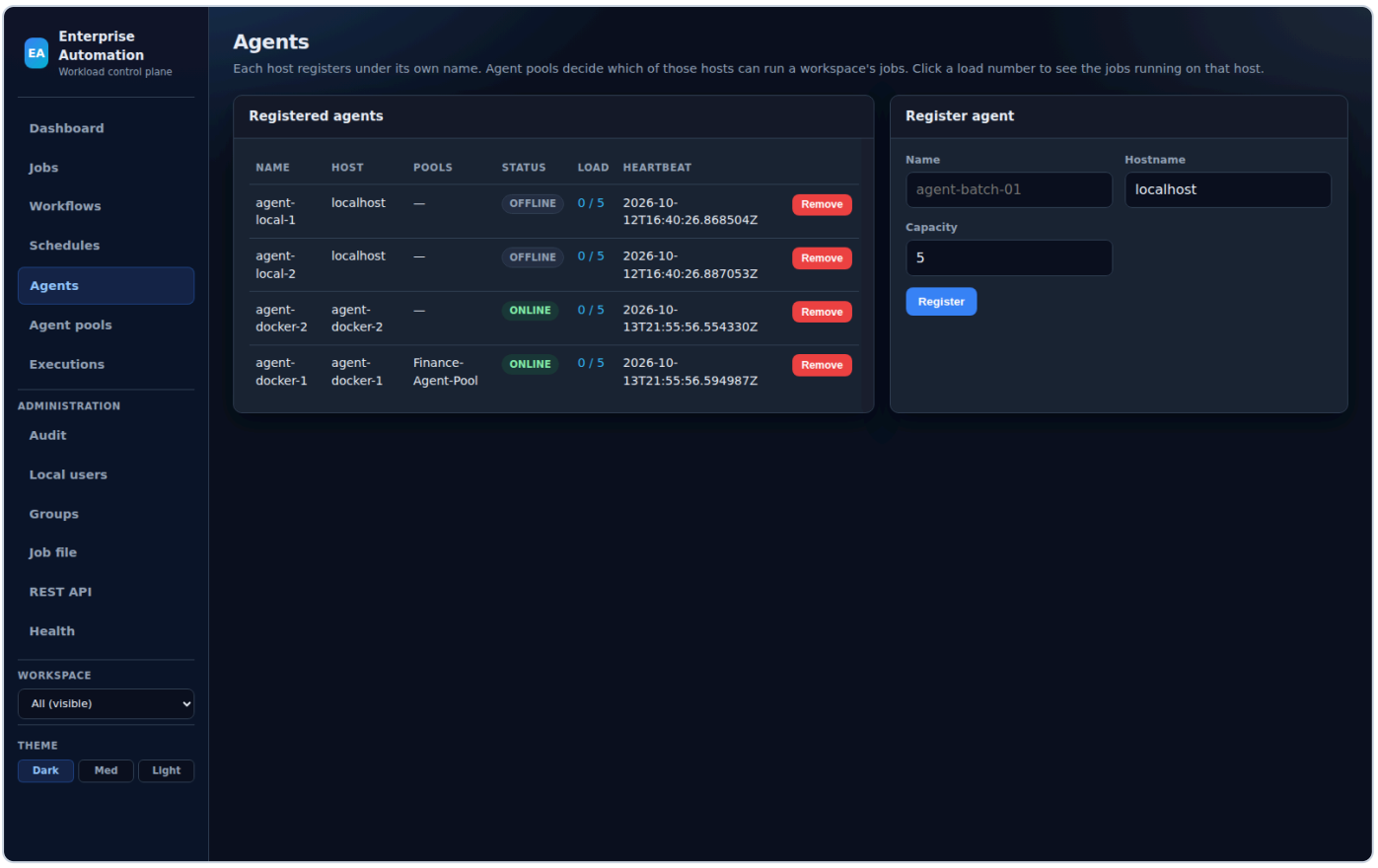


Workflows. Ordered steps. The default stops the workflow when a step fails.

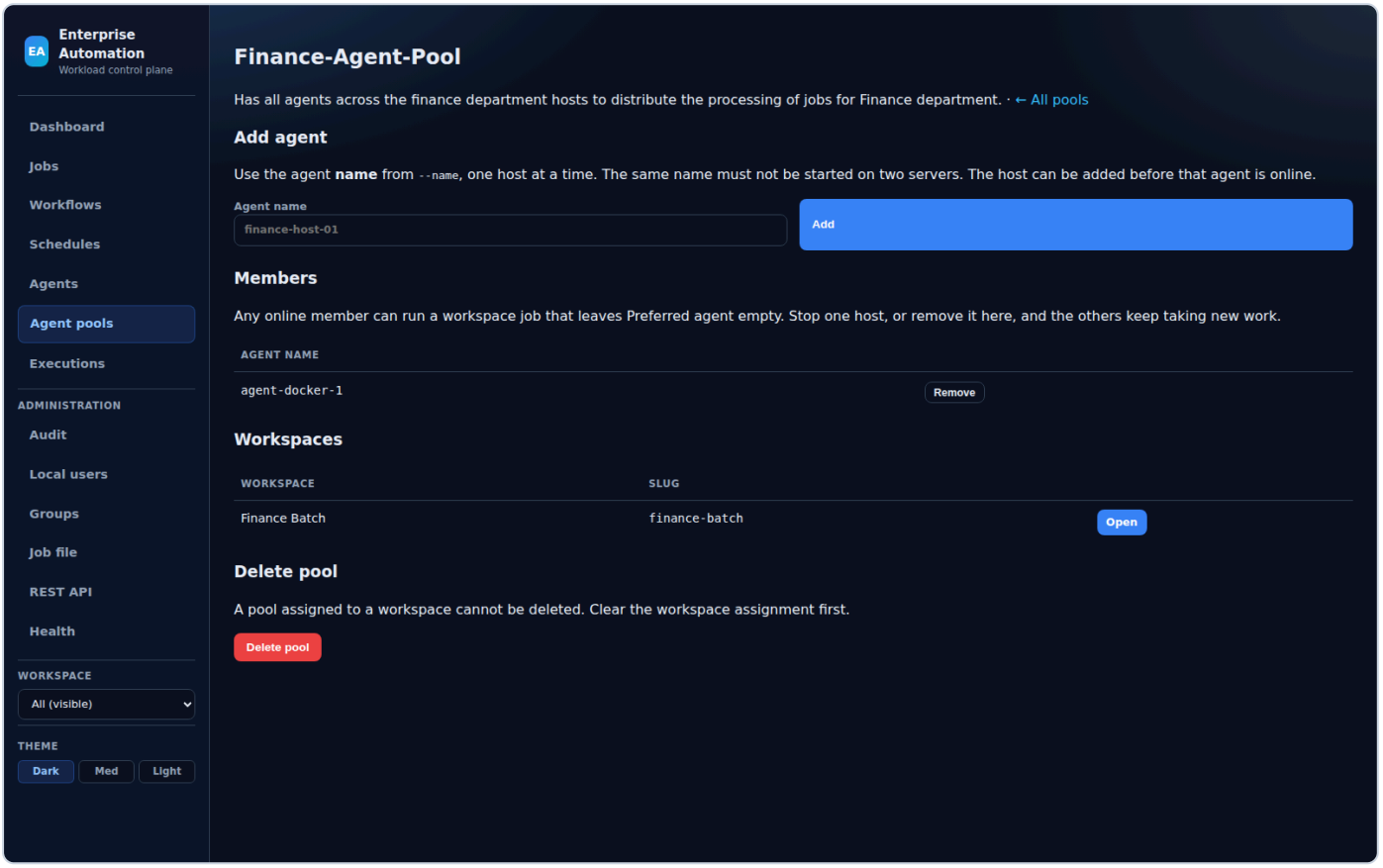


Schedules. Six-field cron. The form uses the numeric job or workflow id. The job file uses workspace and name instead.

Agents and pools

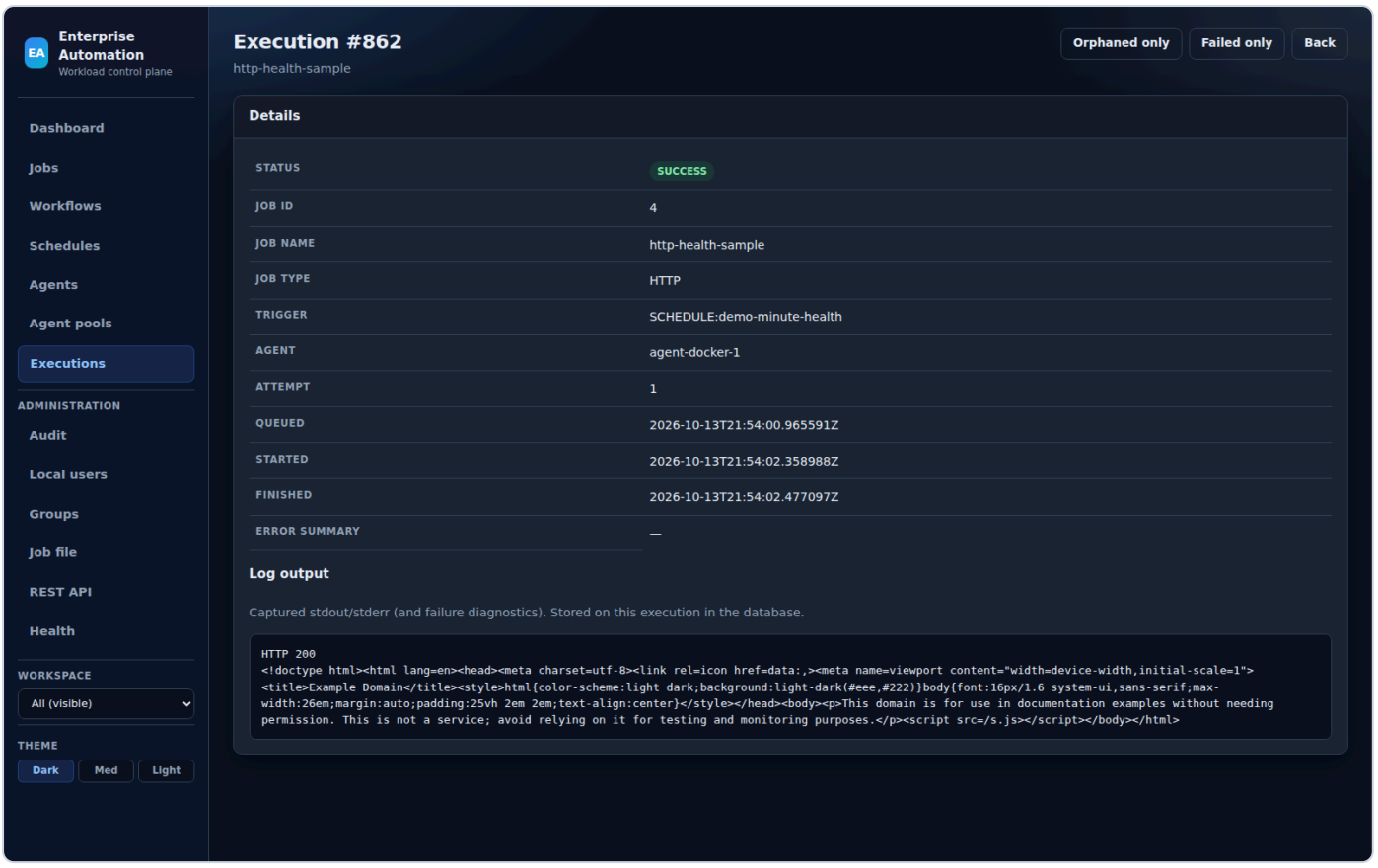


Agents. Name, hostname label, pool, online state, and load. Load is work actually running.

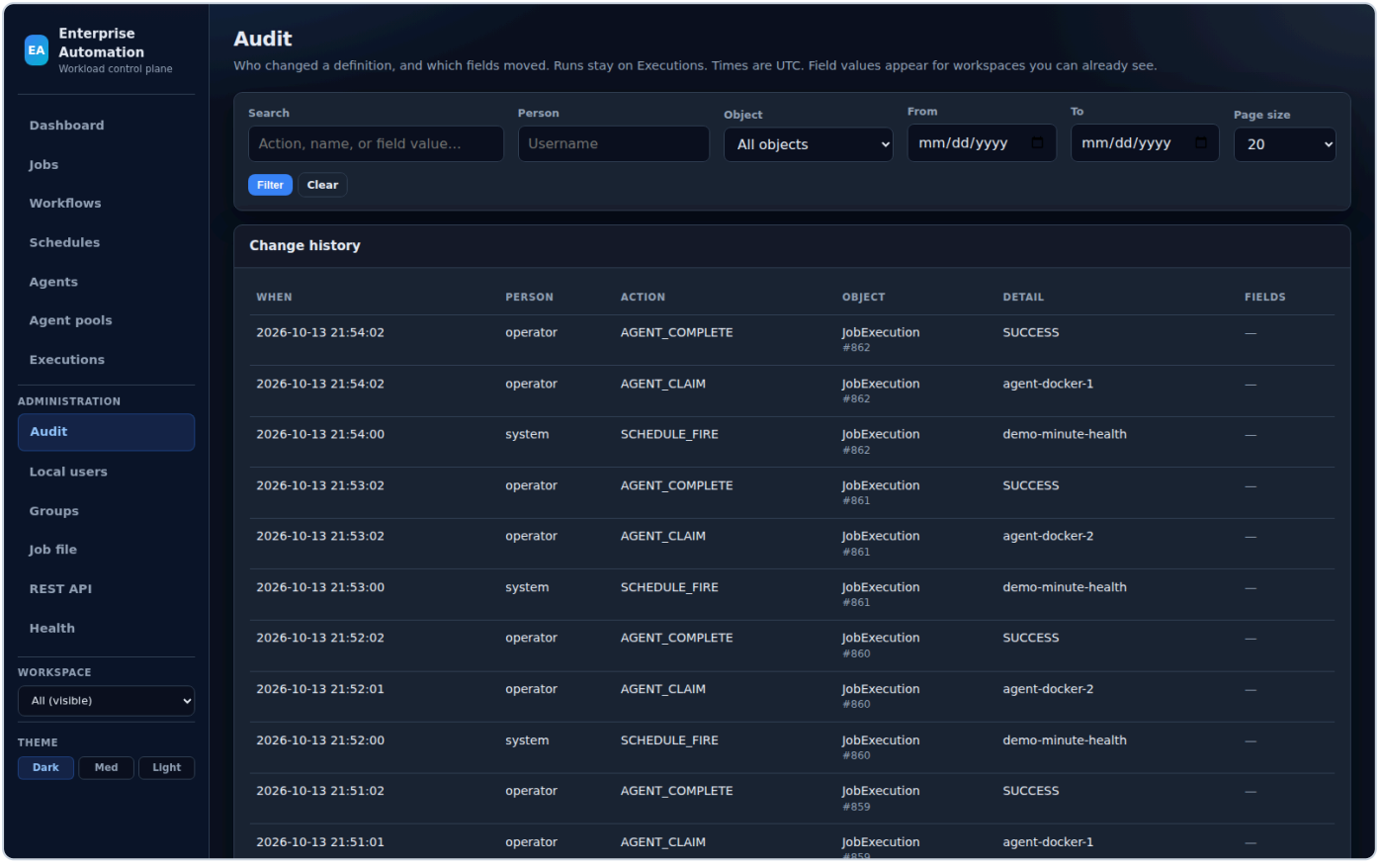


Agent pool. Members are agent names. Any online member can take a job that has no preferred agent.

Executions and audit



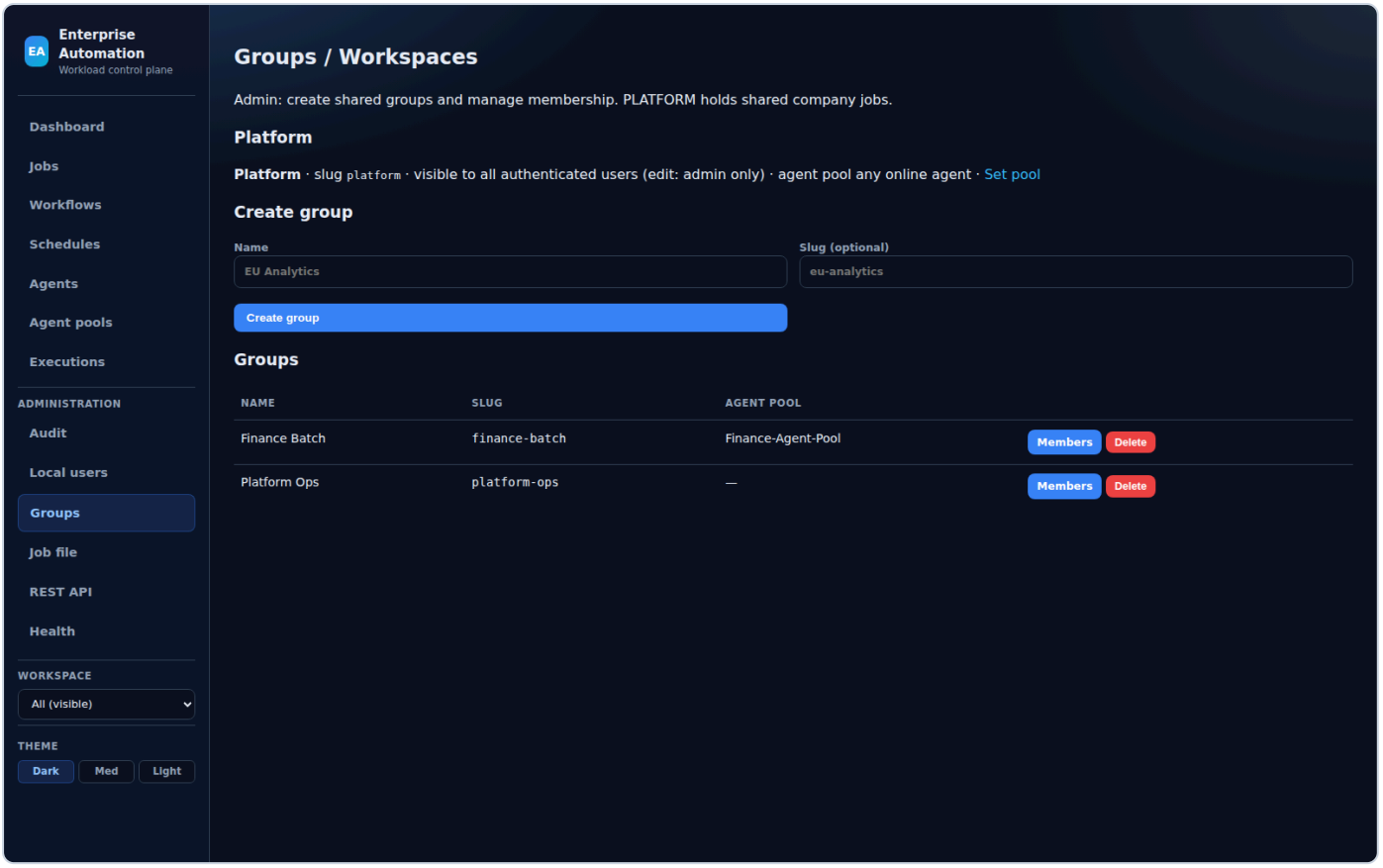
Execution detail. Status, timing, the agent that ran it, and the log. Cancel and requeue are on this page when the run is still open.



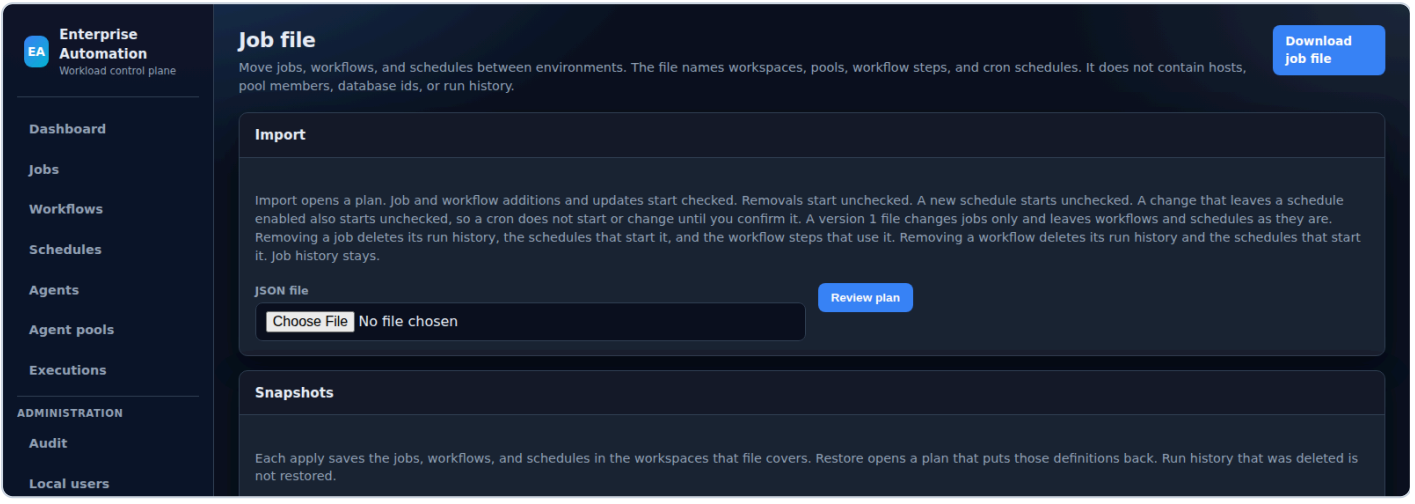
Audit. Searchable history. Definition edits include the fields before and after. Run output stays on the execution.

Administration

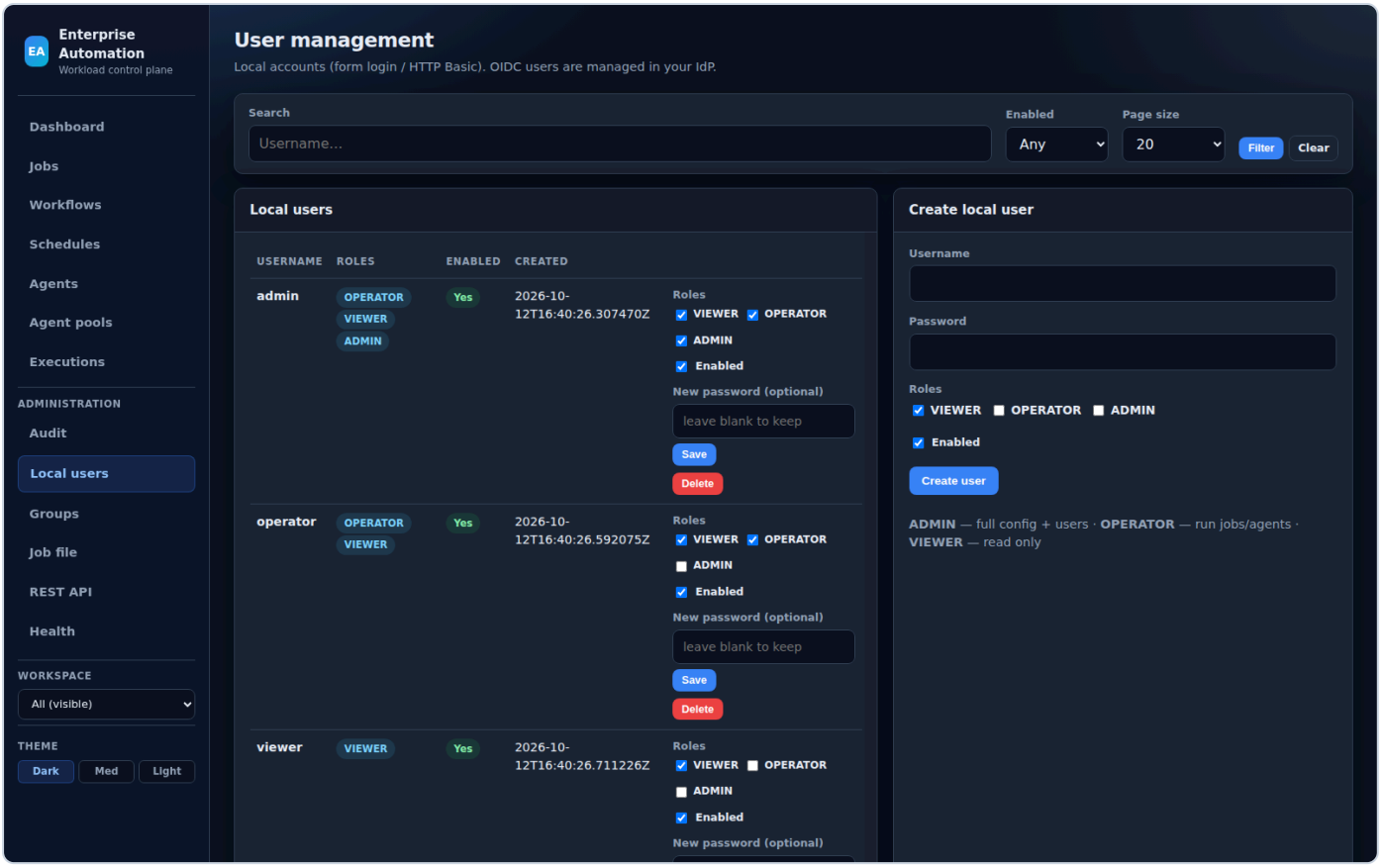
Groups carry the members and the agent pool for that team. Platform stays visible to every signed-in user, and only an administrator edits it.



Groups. Each group can name one agent pool. A pool name in the job file is what moves between environments.



Job file. Download, review a plan, then apply only the confirmed lines. Each apply snapshots those workspaces first.



Local users. Role, enabled flag, and password for a local account. SSO users are managed in the identity provider.

5. Deployment

Just Run It is customer-hosted. People and agents use HTTPS to the control plane. Only application nodes connect to PostgreSQL. Back up that database. It is the durability boundary.

SHAPE	USE
Docker Compose	PostgreSQL, the control plane, and agents. A second application node is available. One database lease keeps a single scheduler.
Kubernetes	Helm chart for the control plane, agents, and optional Postgres.
Bare metal or VM	Java 21 for the control plane. The same agent package on any JVM host.
Local JAR	Sandbox only, with an embedded database. Not the production pattern. Agent mode is the production path. Local mode runs the job inside the control plane.

Use a separate control plane for pre-production when policy requires it, and move definitions with export, review, and apply. Optional email can notify on failure and, if you turn it on, on success. Health and metrics are on the application tier.

6. Day to day

TASK	WHERE
See what failed	Executions, then the failed-only filter, then the log on the detail page
Stop a run	Cancel on the execution. A job that is turned off does not cancel work already queued or running
Recover an orphan	After the process on that host is gone, an operator requeues it. Another pool member can take the new run
Move definitions	Administration, Job file. Review the plan before apply

TASK	WHERE
See who changed a definition	Audit. Filter by person, object, or time
Probe the process	`GET /actuator/health` on the application

Production licenses: Rob@Justrunit.io or 561-523-2049. Leave a message and we will call back.